

ANNUAL REPORT

2006 - 2007



COODU TRUST,

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Annual Report 2006 - 2007

The year 2006-2007 represents a milestone in our activities as we transit and prepare ourselves for intensive grassroots activities to selected blocks and villages in five districts and technical and support services to development efforts in other places.

In earlier years our activities spread across 14 districts, 84 blocks 479 village panchayats directly impacting the lives of nearly 3 million people. The earlier activities were mainly in the area of watershed development and community organization. We note with satisfaction the continuing good work in these 14 districts by the staff members deputed by us to the Government programmes. The 645 SHGs formed by us benefiting 14,000 members function independently and our role in forming them and helping them function independently gives us immense satisfaction and a sense of achievement.

As we decided in 2006, we are moving on to two types of activities, Intensive grassroots activities in selected villages and Technical and support services to development activities wherever needed.

Now we have decided to work intensively among the communities on specific issues affecting them. We have selected Dindigul, Karur, Tirunelveli, Tiruchirappali and Kancheepuram districts for such intensive community development work including, Livelihood, women development, micro credit, health care, sanitation, environment, agriculture, HIV/AIDS and other activities addressing specific local problems for the next 10 years.

Though we have reached a turnover of over 10 million rupees, we have so far worked only on the basis of contracts and billing with government departments and with support from local communities. From this year onwards we have decided to seek funds and partnerships with funding sources outside the Tamil Nadu government based on the suggestions from the committee members and the advisory board members.

I thank all the staff members, community leaders, retired and current government officials, committee members and the advisory board members for their continued overwhelming support for the yet another thoughtful and eventful year.

Warm Regards

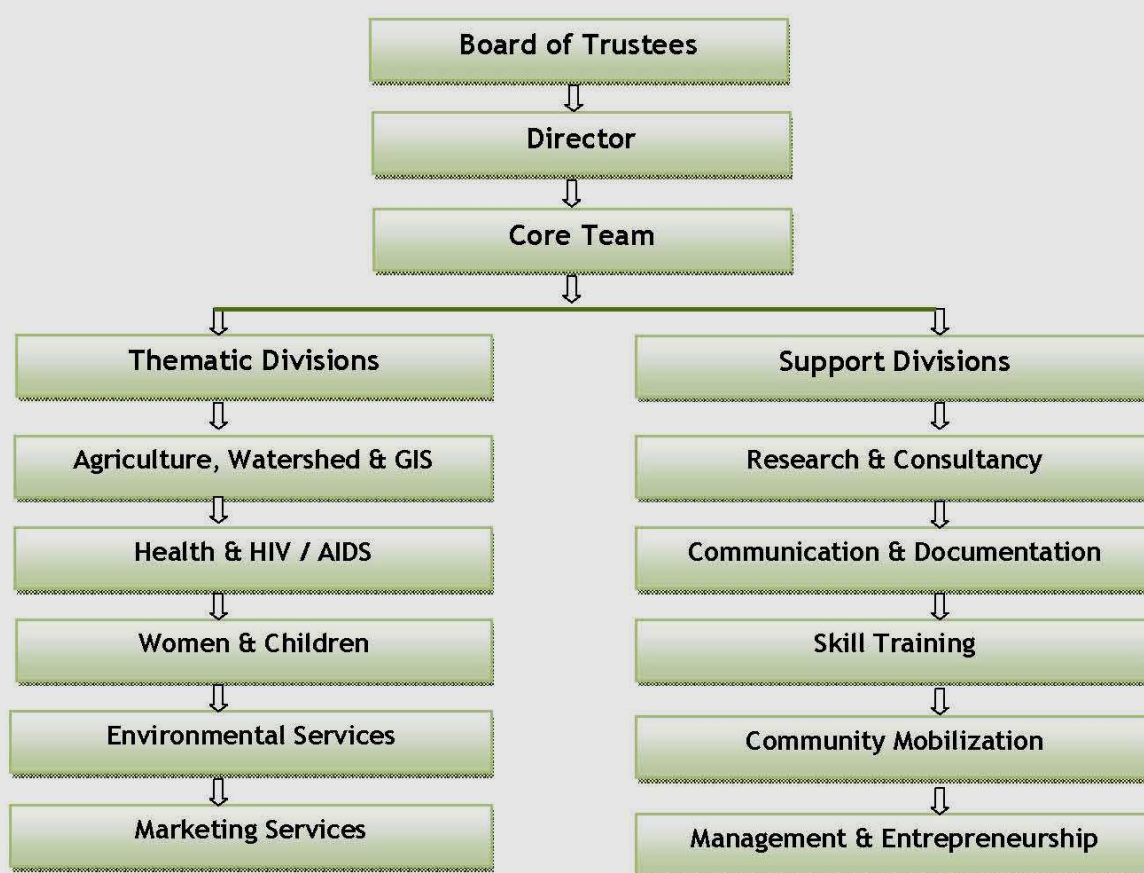
S.Jagadeesan

Director

Organisational Structure

COODU Trust has a rather flat organizational structure with the Founder Director in-charge of the overall functioning of the Trust and answerable to the Board of Trustees that meet periodically to assess and chalk the future strategy of the organization with the able guidance from the advisory board. There are mainly four key divisions - project Division with staff structure in all districts, Training Division under taking programme training as well as skill - based vocational and entrepreneurship training. The administrative division manages personnel and overall project coordination at headquarters. The IT and audio-visual division undertakes documentation and creates audio-visual materials, CD presentation etc. for Coodu Trust.

Organization Structure





Vision

“Creating an egalitarian, self-reliant society by adopting latest and appropriate technologies sustained through participatory community efforts”

Mission

The Mission of Coodu Trust is to create an egalitarian society thereby reducing disparity between classes through a gender-based and human rights approach. It seeks to create a self-reliant society by harnessing use of Information Technology enhancing productivity, speed, accountability and thereby overall efficiency in project management. It also seeks to build relationships within communities by adopting participatory methods, ensuring that the benefits of development reach 'the disadvantaged and marginalized'.

Board of Trustees

Sl.No	Name	Qualification	Office held
1	Mr. S. Jagadeesan	B.Sc., MBA,	Managing Trustee
2	Ms. B. Hemachitra	M.Sc., B.Ed.,	Committee Member
3	Mr. C.T.V. Chidambara Kumar	B.Com,	Committee Member
4	Mr. S. Raja	B.A.,	Committee Member
5	Ms. P. Mahalakshmi	M.Sc., M.Phil,	Committee Member
6	Mr. D. Srinivasan	M.Sc., M.Phil, B.Ed.,	Committee Member
7	Mr. K. Samidurai	M.Sc.,	Committee Member
8	Ms. S. Rani	M.A.,	Committee Member

Advisory Board

Sl. No	Name	Qualification	Designation
1	Shri. C.R.Gunashekar	B.B.A, PGDM (IIPM),	Consultant, UNAIDS(Geneva), UNDP, FHI, New Delhi
2	Dr.Rai	Ph.D.,	Consultant, ICAR, (Rtrd.), New Delhi
3	Dr.Gopal	Ph.D.,	CTO, Kirishi Vikas Kendra (KVK), Gandhigram Rural Institute, Gandhigram.
4	Dr.Raghavan Vasudevan	Ph.D.,	Social Researcher & Director, Prime India Foundation, Chennai
5	Dr. B.R. Dwaraki	M.Sc., Ph.D.,	Professor & Head (Rtrd), Dept. of Sociology, Gandhigram Rural Institute, Gandhigram
6	Dr. K.A. Ponnusamy	M.Sc., Ph.D.,	Professor, Agriculture Extension, Tamil Nadu Agricultural University, Coimbatore
7	Dr. P. J. Pandian -	M.Sc., Ph.D.,	Professor, Agronomy, Tamil Nadu Agricultural University, Killikulam
8	Mr. Rama.Pandian,	B.Sc.,D.Pharm,D.M.L.T	President, Tamil Nad Network of Positive People (TNP+) & Former President, Indian Network of Positive People (INP+)
9	Dr.(Mrs).Girija Prabu	M.B.B.S,	Health Consultant, Karur
10	Mr. P.P. Saravanan	M.Sc (Forestry)	Agro Forestry, KVK, Gandhigram Rural University, Dindigul.
11	Mr.P. Venkatesan	M.Sc (Agri), M.B.A.	Agri. Extn, KVK, Gandhigram Rural University, Dindigul.
12	Mr. C.P.Chandra ban Singh	B.Sc (Agri), M.B.A	Consultant, Deputy Director (Agri)(Rtrd),
13	Mrs.C.Thilagavathy	+2	Chairman, Serukudi Watershed Committee, Serukudi, Tiruchy Dist
14	Mr.T.Ramaiyah	S.S.L.C	Farmer, Mavelipatty
15	Mrs.Saroja	+2	Secretary, Tharagampatti SHGs Federation, Karur Dist

Assets and Infrastructure

Sl.No	Place and District	Assets and Infrastructure
1	Dindigul, Tamil Nadu	2250 sq.ft Building for Office Administration
2	Karur District, Mylampatti,	3500 sq.ft Building of Training Hall with Accommodation facility & 3 Acres land
3	Karur District, Vellianai	50 Acres Agriculture Land
4	Tirunelveli, Moondradaippu	2500 sq.ft Building of Training Hall with Accommodation facility & 6 Acres Agriculture land

Genesis and Growth

Coodu Trust emerged in year 2000 based on the motivation of a few young and dynamic like minded persons and professionals who pledged to do efficient, constructive and everlasting social development work for the under privileged of the society to develop self sufficient and self reliant communities. The name 'Coodu' signifies 'Nest' - a place of rest, comfort and security for those in search of the same. Coodu trust is a not for profit voluntary organization to under take charitable, educational and development activities for the welfare of downtrodden and marginalized needy people of society, including of fourteen districts of Tamil Nadu on watershed programmes and all the thirty districts for various social development work.

Over the years Coodu Trust emerged as one of the leading NGO in watershed development activities in Tamil Nadu especially on community organization and training programmes and research and documentation on various rural development issues. However we have decided in year 2006, to move on to two types of activities, Intensive grassroots activities in selected villages and districts and Technical and support services to development activities wherever needed. We have decided to work intensively among the communities on specific issues affecting them. We have selected Dindigul, Karur, Tirunelveli, Tiruchirappali and Kancheepuram districts for such intensive community development work including, Livelihood, women development, micro credit, health care, sanitation, environment, agriculture, HIV/AIDS and other activities addressing specific local problems for the following years.

The following years are going to be very challenging to create opportunities on specific issues to serve the communities with intensive grassroots activities on diversified development issues.



Activities for the Year 2006-2007

Women Development, Self Help Groups (SHGs) & Micro-Credits

COODU Trust is instrumental in forming 844 men and women Self Help Groups in 11 districts of Tamil Nadu. COODU Trust enabled these SHGs members for revolving fund, economic assistance through SGSY, IWDP, Magalir Thittam, NABAD, THADCO and other nationalized banks. The total financial assistance of nearly 5 Crores Rupees was given to the members of SHGs with the able support of the COODU Trust.

Self Help Groups were formed to promote savings habit among the women SHG members. Coodu Trust trainers addressed the women in watershed areas to explain about the need for the formation of such groups and the importance of the role of women in Self Help Groups. The selected women were trained on income generating activity such as Mushroom Cultivation and vermi-composting. Through such training, women were trained. Over the period of time, each of the SHGs evolve through the processes of Group Formation (leading to Federation), Capital Formation through revolving funds, and Skill Development with a view to provide skills development and motivate women to become women entrepreneurs and leaders. The major viable economic activities that trained SHGs have undertaken include: Community Herbal Nursery, Community Nurseries, Vermi-Casting/ Composting Production Centre, and Mushroom Production Centre.

The poor landless labourers of these SHG members were once struggled for their livelihoods. The intervention from COODU Trust changed the lives of the rural poor and the members wisely used the money for their livelihood development through petty trades, livestock development and small scale cottage industries. Definitively the quality of life of these SHG members is drastically improving over the years.

Watershed Development Programmes and CBOs

COODU trust has been working extensively in 14 districts of Tamil Nadu on watershed development and livelihoods developments of the rural communities. The main components of the watershed programmes are community mobilization, awareness creation, training, conducting Partipatory Rural Appraisal (PRA), Conducting Socio Economic surveys, mid term evaluation, impact evaluation, documentation and state level IEC material preparation for the components of watershed. The whole exercise was covered for the 479 village Panchayats in Tamil Nadu. As a part of the component in watershed development COODU Trust was instrumental in forming 290 CBOs in 9 districts of Tamil Nadu. These associations are the responsible units for the follow up activities and working for the sustainability of the project. All these CBOs were formed, trained and maintained.



Total Sanitation Campaign (TSC)

The scope of activities under Total Sanitation Campaign (TSC) include the view of Water and Sanitation Campaign devise measures to reduce mortality / morbidity due to such water - related diseases, undertake various activities under TSC include construction of individual household latrines the establishment and managing of Rural Sanitary Mart would supply hardware sanitary materials for construction of toilets, construction and supervision of village sanitary complex for Women, up-gradation of Rural Sanitary Latrines, construction of School Toilets and school sanitation awareness programme, construction of Baby-Friendly Toilets and toilets for Anganwadi centres, Waste Water Management, Solid Waste Management, reduction of Pollution in the villages and integrated environmental protection and development.

In order to improve the sanitation conditions of the rural poor we built 7522 individual household low cost latrines in 11 districts. As part of the women economic development activity we are running a rural sanitary mart at our Training center in Mylampatti is managed by trained women.

Agriculture and Organic farming

Agriculture continues to play a fundamental role in the Indian economy. Since independence, India's agricultural policy has aimed at achieving self-sufficiency and thanks to a successive number of agricultural reforms, India has managed to increase its production dramatically. However accessing the new innovations in Agriculture to replicate the technologies on their field is still a nightmarish problem for the rural farming communities. One of our thrust areas for COODU Trust is to address this problem. Over the years we played a bridge role between the research agencies and the grass roots communities for propagating technologies to rural farming communities through our watershed and other project activities.

To test and demonstrate various agriculture innovations one among the initiative is to start practicing organic farming techniques in our trust land. With the technical support from Tamil Nadu Agriculture University (TNAU) and Kirishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) we have initiated precision farming with micro irrigation technologies in small piece of land as a demo activity. These activities are managed as a self supported activity now for the benefit of the rural farming communities in our project area. We have approached National Agriculture Innovation Project (NAIP), under Indian Council for Agriculture Research (ICAR), Ministry of Agriculture, New Delhi for a farmer's livelihoods project which is under consideration now.



Tamil Nadu Health Systems Project (TNHSP)

Providing healthcare services at any form to the rural areas is extremely useful for the rural communities. One among the important services is mortuary van services. Using mortuary van service is unaffordable for the rural poor to handle the dead bodies. Over the years we realize the need of the rural communities and applied for the project with Health Department, Government of Tamil Nadu. The mortuary van services were awarded to us after evaluating our quality work in health and sanitation in watershed development work and other project activities all over Tamil Nadu. We are successfully running a mortuary service in district headquarters Hospital at Dindigul through Tamil Nadu Health Systems Project (TNHSP). We are charging very low affordable cost just to manage the system. People are benefiting from our services especially the poor rural and urban communities.

Health and HIV/AIDS

The changing estimates of people living with HIV in India and state and statistical data on risk behaviour and other prevention indicators perhaps show progress in facing HIV/AIDS. Hopefully we have reached a stage when we are on the last leg of the war against HIV/AIDS. In order to mitigate the spread of HIV/AIDS in all our watershed training programmes there is a separate awareness session for basic facts on HIV/AIDS, ways of spreading the virus, methods of prevention, treatment aspects and stigma & discrimination are explained to the participants in all 534 Panchayats we worked. Individual cases of HIV infections are referred to VCTC and care & support facilities.

While some of us at Coodu Trust have been involved at a field level in research studies on HIV/AIDS prevention, mapping and needs assessments and two of us have the credit of several firsts in HIV related research, evaluation and motivating prevention, care and support efforts in the country. One of us also have the advantage of learning hands on experience from an application of peer driven model of reaching hidden groups in a city outside the state of Tamil Nadu. We have a PhD scholar among us whose doctoral thesis is on Human Rights of People Living with HIV/AIDS (PLHA) in Tamil Nadu. We as an organization did all our health and HIV/AIDS awareness as part of our other project activities.



Geographical Information Systems (GIS)

Over the years with our experience in handling various development activities of rural communities, we have executed different social development techniques like Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA), Timeline, social mapping and social audit to assess and plan for the rural community's development. Preparation of Social Maps, Resource maps and Watershed maps by using cartographical approach based on the information gathered from the PRA exercise is one of the basic activities to prepare a detailed watershed maps. These data were correlated with the taluk gully maps, NRSA maps, secondary records etc. Based on this exercise detailed watersheds maps of 479 village Panchayats were prepared since 2000 in 14 Districts of Tamil Nadu.

The cartographic domain advances in computer hardware and mapping software have already encouraged many planning departments to move from traditional cartographic methods towards digital mapping and geographical information systems (GIS).

Research

Rapid assessment on sustainable livelihoods and economical development options for the DNCs (Piranmalai Kallar) in Dindigul District was undertaken by Coodu Trust. The assessment covers 5 blocks of the district to assess the livelihood conditions of the Piranmalai Kallar communities. The main objectives of the rapid assessment survey was to identify the number of households and villages of Piranmalai Kallar communities, assessment of current livelihood conditions, livelihood opportunities and various possible livelihood options for the economic and social development of the DNC communities.

Documentation

Tourism Hand book preparation

In order to improve the tourism potential and tourists' inflow District Collector Ramanathapuram District awarded tourism hand book development work for our trust. We have prepared a handbook contains the beautiful photographs of all tourism spots, brief notes on the places, contact information of relevant offices, hotels and travel information in the entire district were furnished in the handbook in a lucid way. We have also prepared posters and pamphlets of tourism spots for this district under this project.

Government scheme works documentation

Documenting various government schemes is essential to monitor the development of various projects. In this connection the various NREGA scheme works in Dindugal district were documented for the District Rural development Agency (DRDA) by us. Success story of NREGA schemes were documented for the content development of the website.

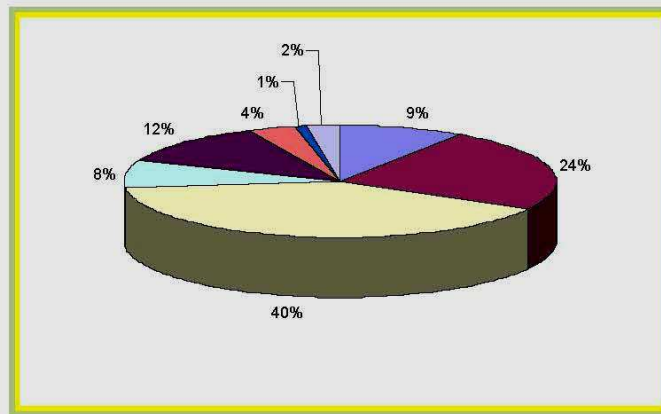
Success stories of the women Self Help Groups (SHGs) activities under Swarnjayanti Gram Swarozgar Yojana (SGSY) were documented in Pudukottai District. We are also undertaking various other media, documentation and printing works in all Government departments.

Planning and research for 24X7 water supply is going on at Maruthur Panchayat, Palayamkottai, Tirunelveli district. Handling Solid waste management work is going on at Koyambedu Market, Chennai

Financial Performance

Financial performance of the Year 2006-2007

	Expenditure Heads	Rs. Lakhs
	Administration	3.91
	Salary and Travel	9.82
	Community Organisation and Training	16.52
	Community Infrastructure	3.29
	IEC, Documentation & Printing	4.93
	Evaluation, SES survey / Benchmark	1.51
	Bank Charges, Audit fees etc.	0.32
	Miscellaneous	1.03
	Total	41.33



Contact Details

Heads	Details
Name of the Organization	COODU Trust
Legal Status	Register No: 150 / 2000 under Indian Trust Act
Financial Approvals	80G & 12A under Income Tax Act FCRA from Ministry of Home Affairs
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Designation	Director
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